3. Accelerate the political and socio-economic integration of the continent.
4. Promote and defend the African common positions on the issues of interest to the continent and its people.
5. Encourage international cooperation, taking due account of the Charter of the United Nations and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.
6. Promote peace, security and stability of the continent.
7. Promote democratic principles and institutions, popular participation and good governance.
8. Promote and protect human and peoples' rights in accordance with the African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights and other relevant human rights instruments.
9. Establish the necessary conditions which enable the continent to play its rightful role in the global economy and in international negotiations.
10. Promote sustainable development at the economic, social and cultural levels as well as the integration of African economies.
11. Promote cooperation in all fields of human activity to raise the living standards of African peoples.
12. Coordinate and harmonize the policies between the existing and future Regional Economic Communities for the gradual attainment of the objectives of the Union.
13. Advance the development of the continent by promoting research in all fields, in particular, in science and technology.
14. Work with relevant international partners in the eradication of preventable diseases and the promotion of good health on the continent.

## The Organs of the AU

***The Assembly:*** It is composed of Heads of State and Government or their duly accredited representatives. The Assembly of Heads of State and Government is the supreme organ of the African Union. The Assembly meets once a year. The decisions are taken either on the basis of consensus or by a two-thirds majority.